

ARROZ CON POLLO

Puerto Rico

INGREDIENTS

For the chicken:

2 tablespoon olive oil, divided
600gms boneless skinless chicken thighs

For the adobo seasoning:

1 teaspoon cumin
3/4 teaspoon paprika
1/2 teaspoon chili powder
1/2 teaspoon red cayenne pepper 1/2
teaspoon onion powder
1/2 teaspoon garlic powder
1/4 teaspoon coriander
1/2 teaspoon salt
Freshly ground black pepper

For the sofrito & rice:

3 cloves garlic, minced
1/4 cup finely diced green pepper 1/4
cup finely diced white onion
1/4 cup finely diced cilantro
Optional: 1 jalapeno, diced
1/4 teaspoon ground coriander
1/4 teaspoon cumin
1/4 teaspoon ground turmeric
1/4 teaspoon garlic powder
1/4 teaspoon oregano
1/4 teaspoon salt
1/4 teaspoon black pepper
1 cup tomato sauce
1 1/4 cups water
1 cup basmati white rice 2/3
cup frozen peas

METHOD

Step 1

Add chicken to a large bowl. Add in 1 tablespoon olive oil and your adobo seasoning: cumin, paprika, chili powder, cayenne pepper, onion powder, garlic powder, coriander, salt and pepper. Use clean hands to toss the chicken in the mixture. Cover and allow chicken to marinate for 30 minutes, or you can skip this completely and begin the cooking process!

Step 2:

Next add remaining 1 tablespoon olive oil to a large deep 10 inch skillet and place over medium high heat. (If you do not have a skillet a large pot will also work very well!) Once oil is hot, add in chicken and season with a little more salt and pepper. Cook until browned 4-5 minutes, then flip and and cook an additional 4-5 minutes. Remove from pan and transfer to a plate.

Step 3:

In the same skillet (it should be greased enough already for sauteing) you will make your sofrito by adding in garlic, jalapeno, diced green pepper, diced onion and cilantro.

Step 4:

Saute for 2-3 minutes, then add in your spices (also known as homemade sazón spices): cumin, turmeric, coriander, garlic powder, oregano, salt and pepper and cook for 30 seconds. Then add in tomato sauce and water and stir well to combine.

Step 5:

Bring to a simmer then fold in the rice and peas, making sure it is evenly distributed. Add browned chicken on top.

Step 6:

Reduce heat to low, cover the skillet immediately and cook for 20-25 minutes.

Step 7:

After 20-25 minutes, most of the liquid should be absorbed and rice should be cooked. Serve immediately. Garnish with cilantro and serve with a squeeze of fresh lime juice.

THE COOKERY

by The Secret Jozi Chef